FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of November 8–14, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — 1 Peter 1:24–25

"The grass withers, and the flower falls, but the word of the Lord remains forever."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Jeremiah 20:1–18; Matthew 24:29–51
Mon: Jeremiah 22:1–23; Matthew 25:1–13
Tue: Jeremiah 23:1–20; Matthew 25:14–30
Wed: Jeremiah 23:21–40; Matthew 25:31–46
Thu: Jeremiah 25:1–18; Matthew 26:1–19
Fri: Jeremiah 26:1–19; Matthew 26:20–35
Sat: Jeremiah 29:1–19; Matthew 26:36–56

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Wake, Awake, for Night Is Flying" — LSB 516

"Wake, awake, for night is flying," / The watchmen on the heights are crying; / "Awake, Jerusalem, arise!" / Midnight hears the welcome voices / And at the thrilling cry rejoices: / "Oh, where are ye, ye virgins wise?"

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Twenty-fourth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 27) November 8, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 84:1, 9–12; antiphon: v. 3*

Even the sparrow finds a home, and the swallow a nest for herself,
at your altars, O LORD of hosts, my King and my God.
How lovely is your dwelling place,
O LORD of hosts!
Behold our shield, O God;
look on the face of your anointed!
For a day in your courts is better than a thousand elsewhere.
I would rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God than dwell in the tents of wickedness.
For the LORD God is a sun and shield; the LORD bestows favor and honor.
No good thing does he withhold from those who walk uprightly.
O LORD of hosts,
blessed is the one who trusts in you!
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Even the sparrow finds a home, and the swallow a nest for herself,
at your altars, O LORD of hosts, my King and my God.

Collect of the Day

To be added from the Sunday service folder.

This Sunday's Readings

Amos 5:18–24 · Psalm 70 · 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18 · Matthew 25:1–13

Gradual *Revelation 7:14b; Psalm 84:5*

These are the ones coming out of the great tribulation.
They have washed their robes and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.
Blessed are those whose strength is in you,
in whose heart are the highways to Zion.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 28)

Zephaniah 1:7–16 · Psalm 90:1–12 · 1 Thessalonians 5:1–11 · Matthew 25:14–30

Learn by Heart: The Seventh Petition of the Lord's Prayer *LSB p. 324*

"But deliver us from evil. What does this mean? We pray in this petition, in summary, that our Father in heaven would rescue us from every evil of body and soul, possessions and reputation, and finally, when our last hour comes, give us a blessed end, and graciously take us from this valley of sorrow to Himself in heaven."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: Ten young women wait for a bridegroom who is late. Five brought extra oil; five did not, and when the cry goes up at midnight there is no time left to borrow. Jesus ends it simply: "Watch therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour." Paul comforts the Thessalonians this Sunday with the reason we can wait without dread — the dead in Christ will rise. This week Jeremiah preaches to a city that will not listen, and Matthew moves toward the upper room. Ask one another: "What would it look like to be ready — not anxious, but ready?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is that great big candle?

The tall candle standing near the baptismal font or the altar is the Paschal Candle. Some candles we light every Sunday; this one is lit at special times — at Easter, at Baptisms, and at funerals.

The Paschal Candle reminds us of Jesus' victory over death. Remember the pillar of fire that led Israel through the night after God rescued them from slavery? When Jesus died, He released us from the slavery of darkness and death. In this Sunday's Gospel, five wise young women keep their lamps burning through the night. That light is His, not ours.

Parents: *Take your children up to look at the Paschal Candle and point out the symbols on it. Remind them that "Jesus Christ is the Light of the world, the Light no darkness can overcome."*

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